of Yula I that would then cut off the other two posts. A second Chinese column started firing mortars at Yula I at first light on 21 October. At 7 a.m. the section at Jamini Tilok could see the Chinese approaching their screening position. As per their operational procedure, the ten men at Jamini Tilok were not expected to put up much of a fight, they were only meant to delay the Chinese assault on Yula II. Opening fire with deadly accuracy, they successfully achieved their objective, falling back on Yula II by mid-afternoon. However, by then, all the men at Yula I had been killed. Apart from one JCO and nineteen men from 1/8 GR, there were two NCOs and nine sappers from the Engineer Regiment among the dead.

Unable to reinforce his besieged positions, Hari Chand was in a desperate situation. He ordered Tokung to launch two boats and try and evacuate the men from Yula II. Naik Rabi Lal Thapa set out to try and rescue the stranded men. At the landing point he found a dozen Gorkhas and two sappers. After taking six men in his boat, he put the other eight in the second vessel. However, during the return journey, the second boat capsized, taking all nine men on board with it. Finally, at 8 p.m. on 21 October, Rabi Lal Thapa reached Tokung with six survivors from the entire Yula Sector.

THE BATTLE FOR CHUSHUL

In the opening round in Ladakh, the Chinese had more or less achieved all their objectives. Flush with their success against the ill-equipped and tiny Indian dispositions, Radio Peking announced rather grandiosely on 24 October that the Chinese would now capture the Chushul airfield.